

Lean Startup, 2DV614 (VT26)

Assignment 1: Individual Assignment

Submission date: 2026-05-31 23:59

Introduction

Assignment 1 is an individual assignment and is mandatory. Not delivering it will result in the failure of the course. Delivering it late may result in a reduced grade.

Background

Imagine you are a computer science student having this great business idea during your studies. The idea starts small and it feels good. You discuss it with your friends and try out this idea with friends and family and you start to be convinced that you are on to something.

Tasks

Before you really commit to the idea, you want to formalize it more and test/validate it with a larger audience. Therefore, the first activities are to document your idea and business model.

1. Find a business idea based on the Design Thinking method talked about in the previous seminar (or another business idea).
2. Write down a list of assumptions and hypotheses you would like to test to see if that idea can be a real opportunity.
3. Do/fill in a business model canvas to document your idea and business model, etc.

After you formalized your business idea, thinking through different scenarios, you put in 50 000 SEK (in time and money (fictive!)) to validate your most important assumptions, i.e., do you really have a value proposition, and can it grow?

4. Validate and document your three most important assumptions of your idea. Do what is necessary to get data that supports or falsifies your hypothesis. Below are some examples of experiments that can be done. These are just examples, remember that interviews are weak as evidence, be creative:
 - a. Present and or test them with your family/friends/fellow students, people you are sharing dorm rooms with, etc. and receive their feedback.
 - b. Ask/propose in social media to see if there is interest, e.g., would anybody buy/pay the service/product?
 - c. Create a web page and see if someone will visit it.
 - d. Use Google Trends to see if someone searches for what you are offering.
5. Document your findings, i.e., what you did and what your conclusions regarding the assumptions are.

Regardless of how successful you were with your validation, assume for the next task that you have enough evidence to proceed, i.e., your assumptions are all valid.

You know that the next step would be to start a company and join a so-called incubator (startup factory). If you do that, you could receive 500 000 SEK in funding to build an MVP so that you can

find out if you really can get customers. You want to know if that is enough funding to get started or if you need to investigate additional options.

6. Do a scenario analysis, i.e., calculate the following:
 - a. The price you need to take for your service/product to be profitable.
 - b. Cost for being able to develop and deliver an MVP (are the 500 000 SEK enough?)
 - c. When do you make break even?
 - d. Do you need to hire UX, copy, marketers, developers?
 - e. What do you think the growth will be (scaling sales)?
 - f. How long does the money you get last?
 - g. What are the consequences of the growing customer base on demands, servers, support, etc.

Summary of Deliverables

1. Filled in Lean Model Canvas (or Business Model Canvas), hypothesis, and proof.
2. Complementing Report as .docx or .pdf (about 5 pages, not including attachments).
 - a. Discussion of your scenario analysis (3 scenarios)
 - i. The one you believe in.
 - ii. Two alternative scenarios (what happens if the market changes, you are running out of money)
 - b. Summary and discussion of your findings.

Submission

The assignment must be submitted on Moodle (see assignment section).